

Iterative TA Maturity Model

A framework for building sustainable talent acquisition infrastructure, from reactive hiring to strategic sourcing.

Establish the Foundation

Reactive hiring gives way to intentional process. The goal is clear ownership, baseline infrastructure, and real visibility into what's happening.

SOURCING MODEL

Demand-driven; managed reactively by team lead

PROCESS

Basic screen-and-submit; demand requests come from hiring leaders

TECHNOLOGY

Core ATS configured; foundational reporting and requisition tracking in place

AI TOOLS

Initial exploration of AI for job description writing and basic candidate matching

OUTREACH

Recruiter-led; messaging is ad hoc and inconsistent across the team

MARKETING

Minimal partnership; employer brand largely undefined

VENDOR USE

High; external agencies fill sourcing gaps

02 OPTIMIZE

Refine & Systematize

With a foundation in place, the focus shifts to closing gaps and making sourcing proactive rather than reactive.

SOURCING MODEL

Agile model; dedicated point of contact per hiring leader and team

PROCESS

Streamlined screen, interview, and offer experience with active feedback loops

TECHNOLOGY

ATS fully utilized; real-time reporting and pipeline dashboards live for hiring managers

AI TOOLS

AI used for outreach personalization, interview scheduling, and sourcing workflow automation

OUTREACH

Templated messaging aligned to role and persona; tested and refined by channel

MARKETING

Active collaboration on employer brand campaigns; recruiting and marketing share content calendar

VENDOR USE

Reduced; internal sourcing handles the majority of requisitions

03 SCALE

Sustain & Evolve

A mature, sustainable sourcing engine. Data drives decisions; the team is strategic, not just transactional.

SOURCING MODEL

Proactive, intelligence-led; passive talent pipeline always active

PROCESS

Firmwide consistency; continuous improvement cycles built in

TECHNOLOGY

ATS integrated across the full talent lifecycle; automation reduces manual work firmwide

AI TOOLS

AI embedded across sourcing, screening, and reporting; team focuses on relationships and judgment

OUTREACH

Brand-consistent, personalized outreach at scale; voice shaped in partnership with marketing

MARKETING

Recruiting is a brand function; team contributes to EVP, social strategy, and candidate experience

VENDOR USE

Minimal; reserved for niche or surge scenarios only